

Wei(Rocio) Zhong

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Stony Brook University	wei.zhong.1@stonybrook.edu https://rociozhong.github.io
ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS	Stony Brook University , Stony Brook, NY Department of Political Science Assistant Professor, Sep 2025 – Present New York University , New York, NY Center for Social Media and Politics Postdoctoral Research Scientist, Sep 2023 – Aug 2025 George Washington University , Washington, DC Institute for Data, Democracy & Politics, School of Engineering and Applied Science Research Scientist, Feb 2021 – Aug 2023	
EDUCATION	University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign , Urbana, IL Ph.D., Political Science, Aug 2021 Dissertation: “Candidates, the Economy and Voting Behavior” M.S., Statistics, May 2018 New York University , New York, NY M.A., Politics, May 2014 University of International Business and Economics , Beijing, China B.A., Spanish, Jun 2009	
RESEARCH INTEREST	Comparative Politics, Political Methodology Online Hate and Extremism, Polarization, Social Media, Computational Methods	
PUBLICATIONS	Zhong, W. , & Broniatowski, D.A. (2023). Economic risk framing increases intention to vaccinate among Republican COVID-19 vaccine refusers. <i>Social Science & Medicine</i> , 317, 115594. Bailard, C., Tromble, R., Zhong, W. , Bianchi, F., Hosseini, P., & Broniatowski, D.A. (2024). “Keep Your Heads Held High Boys!”: Examining the Relationship between the Proud Boys’ Online Discourse and Offline Activities. <i>American Political Science Review</i> , 1–18. Zhong, W. , Bailard, C., Broniatowski, D., & Tromble, R. (2024). Proud Boys on Telegram. <i>Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media</i> , 4, 1–47. Zhong, W. , & Zhang, M. (2025). Subdued but Unbroken: The Cohesion of Far-Right Extremist Followers after Deplatforming. <i>Perspectives on Politics</i> , 1-26. Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Brown, M., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., Zhong, W. , Dahlke, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. <i>Social Media+ Society</i> , 11(2). Zhong, W. , Chen, B., Liang, F. & Zhang, M. (2025). Picturing Protest: A Deep Dive into the Visual Representation of Protests in Authoritarian Countries’ Media on Twitter. <i>Digital Journalism</i> , 1-22 Broniatowski, D., Zhong, W. , W., Simons, J.R., Jamison, A.M., Dredze, M., & Abrams, L.C. (2025). Explaining Twitter’s inability to effectively moderate content during the COVID-19 pandemic. <i>Scientific Reports</i> , 15(1), 36096.	

UNDER REVIEW REVISE AND RESUBMIT	Suk, J.*, Zhong, W.*, Zhang, Y., Pruden M., Yang, Y., Mao, C., & DiFranzo D. Unveiling Engagement and Platform Algorithmic Biases in Social Media Data Collection and Analysis: An Experimental Study. [*co-first author] Zhong, W. From Policy to Personality: How Americans Evaluate Presidential Candidates, 1984–2020. Zhong, W.*, Sanderson, Z.*, & Tucker, J.A. It Works When It Works: Measuring the Direct and Indirect Effects of AI Labels on Political Images. [*co-first author] Zhong, W., Tan, H., Wang, B., & Zhang, K. The U.S.–China Media War: A Cross-National Antagonistic Spiral
SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS	Zhong, W., & Bisbee J. From Streets to Screens: The Influence of Offline Confrontations on Online White Supremacist Community Unity Zhong, W., Much, M., Nagler, J., & Tucker, J.A. Tweets and Beliefs: Online Political Environments and Immigration Attitudes Zhong, W., & Nagler, J. Opinion Change and Voter Learning across Political Issues in U.S. Elections. Zhong, W., Xu, X., & Chen, H. The Rise and Contestation of Identity in Global Media
SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	US 2020 Presidential Election Researcher Dec 2021 - Sep 2023 META (formerly Facebook) Menlo Park, CA Data Science Research Intern May 2019 - Aug 2019 DiDi AI LABS Beijing, China
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor POL 201 Introduction to Statistical Methods in Political Science, Stony Brook University Spring 2026 POL 604 Quantitative Analysis III (Graduate), Stony Brook University Fall 2025 PS 385 Politics of the European Union (Online), UIUC Spring 2020 PS 241 Comparative Politics in Developing Nations (Online), UIUC Fall 2019, Spring 2018 Teaching Assistant Quantitative Analysis I, II, III (Graduate), UIUC 2018–2019 Introduction to Political Research, UIUC Spring 2017 Introduction to International Relations, UIUC Spring 2016
LANGUAGES	English(fluent), Chinese(native), Spanish(proficient)
SOFTWARE	Python, R, SQL, LATEX, Git, ArcGIS
SERVICES	Manuscript Referee American Political Science Review, Political Behavior, Political Communication, Journal of Experimental Political Science, PNAS Nexus, Nature Communications Guest Editor Special Issue on Multi-Platform Research for <i>Political Communication</i>